

Building Up: A One-Page Introduction

A plain-language introduction to Building Up: Alberta Accessibility and Inclusion Blueprint

WHAT THIS DOCUMENT IS

Building Up is a proposed framework for Alberta accessibility and inclusion legislation. It is not a request for a single program change. It is a draft of what a comprehensive Alberta accessibility law could look like, written in the technical legal language that legislation requires.

WHAT IT ASKS FOR

Building Up proposes that Alberta enact legislation that would:

- **Define disability broadly and inclusively** — including invisible, episodic, fluctuating, and progressive disabilities, not only permanent and severe conditions. The current AISH and PDD systems require a person to demonstrate continuous, severe, permanent disability. Building Up's proposed definition recognizes that disability does not work that way for many people.
- **Operate independently of program eligibility** — a person whose impairment does not meet AISH's severity threshold is still protected under the legislation, even if they do not qualify for AISH itself.
- **Address barriers, not diagnoses** — adopting the social model of disability used in the UN Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities. The legislation protects against barriers in the built environment, in services, in information, in attitudes, and in policy itself, regardless of the diagnostic label attached to a person's disability.
- **Establish a meaningful consultation framework** — requiring that policy decisions affecting disabled Albertans involve actual consultation with disabled Albertans, not stakeholder bodies that exclude the affected population.
- **Recognize intersecting identities** — including Indigenous disability, 2SLGBTQ+ disability, racialized disability, and newcomer disability, and the substantive realities of how disability operates across those communities.

WHY THIS DOCUMENT READS THE WAY IT DOES

Building Up is written in technical legislative language because it is proposing actual statutory text. That precision is the protective function. A plain-language version of the legislation itself would lose what the precise wording is built to deliver. This one-pager is a separate piece — it introduces Building Up. The companion document *What This Would Mean for Me* addresses the everyday impact of the proposed legislation for affected Albertans.

WHERE TO FIND THE FULL DOCUMENT

The full Building Up: Alberta Accessibility and Inclusion Blueprint is available at albertadisabilitysystembreakdown.netlify.app.

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown — Advocate

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